

# AI Fluency Essentials

A calm, practical introduction for people who want to understand LLMs, use them safely, and build confidence with ordinary work tasks.

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| Format   | One 90-minute Zoom session with guided practice and a follow-up handout.                                                      |
| Level    | Level 1: shared team AI fluency                                                                                               |
| Audience | Curious professionals, mixed-comfort teams, and organizations that need a shared starting point before deeper tool decisions. |

## Learner outcomes

- Explain what LLMs are good at, where they fail, and why human review matters.
- Use a basic prompting loop for drafting, summarizing, planning, and asking better questions.
- Recognize sensitive-data boundaries and safer ways to practice with non-sensitive examples.
- Leave with shared vocabulary for prompts, context, output quality, uncertainty, and review.

## Guiding questions

- What does our team need to understand before choosing tools or policies?
- Which everyday tasks are safe places to build skill?
- How should we review AI output before it affects real work?
- What shared language will help us discuss AI without hype or fear?

## Readiness checks

- Participants can describe AI as an assistive drafting and reasoning partner, not an authority.
- Participants can use a repeatable prompt structure.
- Participants can explain the difference between safe examples and sensitive operational data.
- Participants can name a human review habit they will use before applying output.

## Research-backed adoption practices

- Build shared vocabulary before asking a team to adopt new tools or policies.
- Normalize careful experimentation so people can ask basic questions without embarrassment.
- Make quality control and critical thinking explicit parts of AI fluency, not advanced extras.
- Give managers and team leads enough fluency to model responsible use and reinforce boundaries.

## Curriculum modules

### The practical mental model

Participants learn how prompts, context, instructions, examples, and review shape an AI session without needing technical background.

### Prompting as conversation design

We practice turning vague requests into useful context, constraints, examples, and review questions.

### Safe experimentation

The session establishes clear boundaries around patient, customer, employee, legal, financial, and proprietary information.

### Confidence routines

Participants leave with small repeatable habits: draft, critique, revise, verify, and decide what still needs human judgment.

### Team language and norms

The group names simple shared expectations for AI use, including what to try, what to avoid, and how to talk about uncertain outputs.

## Session flow

### Baseline

Surface current comfort levels, hopes, concerns, and common misconceptions.

### Model

Teach a practical mental model for context, instructions, examples, model output, and review.

### Practice

Run guided prompt exercises using neutral scenarios that resemble the team's work without exposing sensitive data.

### Review

Apply a quality checklist to outputs and discuss what should be verified, revised, or discarded.

### Normalize

Close with team language, safe-use reminders, and a first set of practice habits.

## Practice labs

### Prompt anatomy lab

Rewrite a weak prompt into a stronger one by adding role, task, context, audience, constraints, and success criteria.

### Output comparison

Compare two model responses and identify which is more useful, what is missing, and what should be checked.

### Data-boundary sorting

Sort example inputs into safe public practice, caution, and private-data categories.

### Revision ladder

Practice moving from first draft to better draft through critique, constraint, and audience-shift prompts.

## 1-2 hour utility projects

These short projects are designed to help individuals experience practical AI utility while keeping inputs safe and human review visible.

## How to choose a strong first project

- Real work, low risk: choose a task people already recognize, but keep inputs public, fictional, or sanitized.
- Clear walk-away artifact: produce a brief, agenda, checklist, glossary, comparison table, or reusable prompt sequence.
- Visible judgment step: check claims, name uncertainty, revise tone, or decide what should remain human-led.
- Transferable habit: practice a pattern the learner can reuse later, such as giving context, comparing outputs, or verifying before relying.

### Learning Sprint (60-75 minutes)

Turn a confusing topic into a private tutor session.

**Walk-away artifact:** A one-page explainer, a short quiz, a glossary, and a list of what to verify elsewhere.

**Safe input:** Use a public topic, a public article, or a concept you want to understand. Avoid private client, patient, employee, or proprietary material.

- Ask for a plain-language explanation at your current level.
- Request examples, analogies, common misconceptions, and a five-question quiz.

- Ask what claims need source checking before you rely on them.

**Starter prompt:** Teach me [topic] as a smart beginner. Start with a plain-language explanation, then give examples, common misconceptions, a short glossary, a five-question quiz, and a list of claims I should verify with reliable sources.

### Decision Clarity Brief (75-90 minutes)

Use AI to make a decision easier to think about without outsourcing the decision.

**Walk-away artifact:** A comparison table, assumptions list, pre-mortem, missing-information checklist, and final decision questions.

**Safe input:** Use a personal, public, fictional, or sanitized decision. Keep confidential finances, contracts, medical, legal, or customer details out of public tools.

- Describe the options, constraints, values, and what would count as success.
- Ask AI to compare options and surface assumptions instead of choosing for you.
- Run a pre-mortem and identify what a human should check before acting.

**Starter prompt:** Help me think through this decision without deciding for me: [safe decision context]. Create criteria, compare options, name assumptions, run a pre-mortem, list missing information, and end with questions I should answer myself.

### Meeting Prep Kit (60-90 minutes)

Turn a rough meeting idea into a more useful conversation.

**Walk-away artifact:** A meeting agenda, prep questions, likely tensions, decision points, and a follow-up email template.

**Safe input:** Use fictional or sanitized meeting context. Do not paste private attendee notes, personnel details, patient data, customer records, or proprietary plans into public tools.

- Give AI the purpose, audience, desired outcome, and any safe background.
- Ask for an agenda, questions, risks, and decisions to clarify.
- Revise the agenda for tone, time, and who needs to review it.

**Starter prompt:** Using this fictional or sanitized meeting context, create a focused agenda, prep questions, likely tensions, decision points, and a follow-up email template. Mark anything that needs human confirmation: [context].

### Writing Upgrade Studio (60 minutes)

See how AI can draft, critique, and revise with you in a loop.

**Walk-away artifact:** A stronger email, memo, bio, announcement, or short article with a revision history and review checklist.

**Safe input:** Use a rough draft that contains no sensitive personal, client, patient, employee, legal, financial, or proprietary details.

- Ask for a first rewrite for a specific audience and tone.
- Ask AI to critique its own draft for clarity, claims, tone, and missing context.
- Request a final revision and make the last edits yourself.

**Starter prompt:** Improve this rough draft for [audience] with a [tone] tone. Then critique your revision for clarity, unsupported claims, missing context, and anything a human should verify before sending: [safe draft].

### **Research Compass (90-120 minutes)**

Use AI to plan research before you read, search, or cite.

**Walk-away artifact:** A research question map, search terms, source categories, red flags, and verification plan.

**Safe input:** Use a public topic or general business question. Do not ask AI to invent citations or make final claims without sources.

- Ask AI to turn a broad topic into better questions and search terms.
- Request source categories, possible biases, and missing perspectives.
- Use the output as a reading plan, then verify claims in actual sources.

**Starter prompt:** Help me plan research on [public topic]. Create key questions, search terms, source types to seek, likely blind spots, red flags, and a verification checklist. Do not make final claims without sources.

### **Workflow Recipe Builder (90-120 minutes)**

Turn one repeated task into a reusable AI-assisted workflow.

**Walk-away artifact:** A workflow recipe with inputs, prompt sequence, review gates, human owner, and when-not-to-use guidance.

**Safe input:** Choose a recurring task and describe it generally or with fictional examples. Keep sensitive operational data out of public tools.

- Map the task into steps, inputs, outputs, review points, and handoffs.
- Ask AI where it can help and where human judgment should stay in charge.
- Create a repeatable prompt sequence and a review checklist.

**Starter prompt:** Turn this recurring task into a safe AI-assisted workflow recipe: [task]. Include purpose, safe inputs, prompt sequence, review checkpoints, human decision points, risks, and when not to use AI for this task.

### **Professional Profile Refresh (75-90 minutes)**

Use AI as a coach for describing your work more clearly.

**Walk-away artifact:** A refreshed bio, resume bullet options, interview talking points, and confidence-building practice questions.

**Safe input:** Use a sanitized career summary or fictionalized role description. Do not include private employer data, references, compensation, or confidential projects.

- Give AI a safe summary of your work, audience, and desired tone.
- Ask for clearer positioning, bullet options, and examples of evidence to add.
- Roleplay interview questions and revise anything that feels inflated or inaccurate.

**Starter prompt:** Using this sanitized professional summary, help me describe my work more clearly. Draft a short bio, five resume bullet options, three interview talking points, and questions I should answer to make the claims more accurate: [summary].

### Personal Planning Co-Pilot (60-75 minutes)

Use AI to turn vague goals into a realistic plan you can actually follow.

**Walk-away artifact:** A one-week plan, prioritized task list, obstacle plan, review ritual, and next-action checklist.

**Safe input:** Use personal goals and constraints that are not private, medical, financial, legal, or deeply sensitive.

- Describe the goal, constraints, time available, and what has made it hard.
- Ask AI for a practical plan with tradeoffs and small next actions.
- Review the plan yourself and remove anything unrealistic or intrusive.

**Starter prompt:** Help me turn this goal into a realistic one-week plan: [safe goal]. Ask clarifying questions if needed, then create priorities, daily actions, likely obstacles, a review ritual, and a simple checklist.

## Tangible cases

### Shared vocabulary kickoff

**Situation:** A leadership group and frontline staff are using different words for prompts, outputs, hallucinations, and review.

**Learner task:** Create a shared glossary and test it against everyday examples so the group can discuss AI without confusion.

**Starter prompt:** Create a plain-language glossary for a team learning AI. Define prompt, context, output, hallucination, review, sensitive data, and human judgment. For each term, give a workplace example and a common misconception.

### Nonprofit communications draft

**Situation:** A nonprofit team wants to draft a donor update from public program facts and a fictional event recap.

**Learner task:** Practice drafting, audience adaptation, and review without using donor records or private beneficiary details.

**Starter prompt:** Draft a donor update using only the public facts and fictional event notes below. Make it warm, specific, and modest. Then list what a staff member should verify before sending: [public facts and fictional notes].

### Healthcare admin FAQ practice

**Situation:** A cautious health care admin team wants AI practice that does not involve patient information.

**Learner task:** Use a fictional policy FAQ to practice summarizing, tone adjustment, and boundary setting.

**Starter prompt:** Using this fictional clinic FAQ, rewrite the answer for a general audience. Do not add medical advice. Flag anything that should be reviewed by the appropriate internal owner before publication: [fictional FAQ].

## Prompt library

### Team baseline

Ask five questions that help a mixed-comfort team describe what they know about AI, what worries them, and what they want to learn. Keep the questions nontechnical and practical.

### Prompt anatomy

Rewrite this vague prompt into a stronger one with role, task, audience, context, constraints, examples, and success criteria. Explain what changed and why: [rough prompt].

### Output comparison

Compare these two AI outputs. Which is more useful, more accurate, clearer, and safer to use? Name what still needs human review before either one is applied: [output A] [output B].

### Boundary sort

Sort these example inputs into safe public practice, caution, and do not paste into public AI tools. Give a short reason for each decision: [example inputs].

## Materials to develop

- AI fluency starter guide
- Prompt pattern quick sheet
- Sensitive-data boundary checklist
- Output review checklist
- Team language and norms worksheet

## Diagram candidates

These are intentionally left as candidate visuals until diagram parameters are chosen.

- LLM session loop: prompt, context, output, review, revision
- Safe-data boundary map for public AI tools
- Team fluency ladder from curiosity to useful practice

## Follow-up work

- Run one safe prompt experiment before the next meeting.
- Collect examples of confusing, useful, or unreliable AI outputs for discussion.
- Identify one team workflow that may deserve deeper workshop treatment.



## Session design reminders

- Keep examples non-sensitive and realistic.
- Emphasize education, judgment, review, and careful experimentation.
- Do not promise legal, medical, compliance, cybersecurity, or automation outcomes.
- Name when a stronger tool, private environment, or policy decision is needed before proceeding.

## API and tool boundary

This curriculum companion does not require an API call. Any secure password protection, private client portal, or live AI workflow exercise that transmits data to an external model should be reviewed before implementation.